

GENERAL MARKING CRITERIA QUALITATIVE SUBJECTS

(POSTGRADUATE STUDIES)

	Outstanding Quality : 80-100%	Excellent work: 70% -79%	Above satisfactory work: 60% - 69%	Satisfactory: 50 - 59%	Failure: Below 50%
Relevance	Innovatively addresses objectives of the assessment task, especially those components requiring sophistication of critical analysis, synthesis and evaluation.	Excellent knowledge and understanding of material and an imaginative sense of its relevance across a range of issues, and context or policy situation; excellent use of course material and other relevant information to support argument	Very good use of course material and other information; well chosen to support arguments relevant to question	Competent use of course materials and other information to support most arguments	Little or no sign of relevance
Content	A clear and consistent line of highly critical and evaluative argument, displaying the ability to develop one's innovative ideas from the work of others. Creative flair in theoretical and conceptual analysis.	Independent and creative, and demonstrates clear thinking; ability to analyse and critically evaluate material	Good knowledge and understanding of the material, across a broad spectrum, combined with an ability to evaluate, analyse and reflect on key issues	Reasonable knowledge of the material and ability to draw upon more than one source for ideas; uses key themes well.	Very limited knowledge and understanding and the issues involved
Depth	Wide range of recommended and relevant sources used in an innovative and consistent way to support arguments. In depth use of sources beyond recommended texts, demonstrates creative flair in independent research.	A sensitive awareness of conflicting arguments and ideas and of their provenance. Clear grasp of implications.	Well organised use of most of the major points with an ability to draw upon them creatively and critically; awareness of conflicting arguments and ideas and attempt to address them in context	Capacity to grapple with conflicting arguments and ideas; beginning to draw together and synthesise ideas and perspectives from a range of theory	Lack of awareness of conflicting arguments and ideas
Structure	Outstanding visual and written presentation. Sophisticated yet clear and accessible style. Very good standards of vocabulary, syntax, spelling and punctuation. Possibly innovative yet logical and fluent organisation and development of materials. Articulate, coherent and succinct. Relationships between statements and sections are clear and precise. Referencing is accurate and, appropriate.	Excellent organisation of material; clear, logical flow of argument; good sign-posting throughout.	Good, clear framework and reasoned argument with evidence of careful thought	Sensible use of major points integrated into the answer; logical flow of ideas is apparent	Little or no evidence of planned structure and organisation
Style	Exceptional display of understanding, exploration, insight and/or research. Potential for publication/exhibition and/or ability to undertake further research. Evidence of effective communication of work to specialist and non-specialist audiences	Fluent use of written language; theory is fluently drawn in to illuminate and evidence the arguments. Comprehensive and accurate and comprehensive use of Harvard system	Good use of written language; theory is appropriately integrated and correctly presented. Accurate and comprehensive use of Harvard system	Adequate use of written language; meaning is conveyed, although not always clearly; theory used, but not be very well integrated or appropriately used. Limited use of Harvard system	Meaning is very hard to follow due to confusing use of language. Little or no use of Harvard system